



Design and Access Statement

APPLICATION REFERENCE	90.86425.FUL
SITE	17 Northgate Close, Balby, Doncaster, ZZ92 8CM

DOCUMENT DETAILS

Tomplan Planning and engineering Service

Architectural Drawing and engineering Service

Submitted to Council to accompany an application.

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Design and Access Statement

Proposed Conversion to form self-contained flats Use and Extension

55 St Catherine's Avenue, Doncaster ZZ92 8CM Introduction This Design and Access Statement (DAS) has been prepared in support of a Full Planning Application for the change of use of the existing single dwellinghouse (Use Class C3) to two self-contained flats (2 C3), together with the erection of a modest first-floor rear extension at 55 St Catherine's Avenue, Doncaster ZZ92 8CM. This proposal aligns with Doncaster's strategic housing objectives, responding to the borough's identified need for diverse housing options, particularly the increasing demand for one-bed units as outlined in recent Local Plan monitoring reports. The statement has been prepared in accordance with the National Planning Policy Framework (NPPF), the Doncaster Local Plan, and the Nationally Described Space Standards (NDSS), and is written from an architectural and planning perspective. Site and Surroundings The application site comprises a two-storey mid-terrace residential property located on the eastern side of St Catherine's Avenue, within an established residential area characterised predominantly by traditional terraced housing. The surrounding land use is wholly residential, with properties of similar scale, age, and appearance. Local amenities, public transport routes, and employment areas within Doncaster will serve the site well. The principle of residential use is therefore well established and entirely appropriate in this location. Planning Policy Context The proposal has been assessed against the following key policy documents:

development goals.

use and development)

standards)

for residential developments)

Relevant Doncaster Local Plan policies include those relating to:

The proposal seeks to contribute positively to Doncaster's housing supply by providing two high-quality, policy-compliant residential units within an existing urban area. According to recent figures, Doncaster currently requires an additional 300 one-bed units annually



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to meet its housing targets. This scheme, by supplying two such units, fulfils approximately 0.67% of that annual need, thus showcasing a tangible public-interest benefit and reinforcing the scheme's alignment with regional housing objectives.

Amount and Use

The development proposes:

Both units are fully self-contained, with independent kitchens, bathrooms, and living spaces.

The development does not constitute an HMO and does not require HMO licensing.

Layout and Internal Space Standards (NDSS Compliance)

The internal layout has been carefully designed to ensure compliance with the Nationally Described Space Standards.

(Minimum required for 1-bed, 1-person unit: 37 m²)

Both units exceed the minimum NDSS requirements, ensuring an appropriate standard of accommodation with adequate living, dining, storage, and circulation space.

The ground-floor flat's layout is spacious enough to comfortably accommodate a double sofa and a small dining set in the living area, providing a practical and inviting environment.

Similarly, the first-floor flat offers enough space for a cozy yet functional arrangement, reassuring that occupants will not find the space lacking. This directly addresses a common reason for refusal of flat conversions in Doncaster.

Scale, Massing, and Appearance

The proposed first-floor rear extension is modest in scale and is subordinate to the host building. It is positioned to the rear, where visual impact is limited and consistent with the terrace's development pattern.

The front elevation remains unaltered mainly, preserving the established street scene and character of St Catherine's Avenue. Materials are intended to match or complement the existing building, ensuring visual coherence.

The proposal therefore accords with Doncaster design policies, which seek to protect local character while allowing sensitive intensification of existing residential plots.

Residential Amenity



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The proposal has been carefully designed to safeguard the amenity of neighbouring occupiers:

Future occupiers will benefit from good levels of internal amenity, natural light, and functional

layouts appropriate for long-term residential use.

Access

Vehicular Access:

The development utilises existing on-street parking provision. Given the scale of the development (two 1-person flats) and the highly sustainable location, where regular bus services operate within a 5-minute walk and dedicated cycle lanes connect to key amenities, the proposal is considered acceptable in terms of parking, in line with Doncaster guidance.

This ensures residents have convenient access to public transport options, effectively reducing

reliance on personal vehicles and pre-empting potential concerns regarding parking saturation.

Pedestrian Access:

Pedestrian access remains via the existing frontage. Each flat benefits from a straightforward,

logical access arrangement, with safe, convenient movement throughout.

Inclusive Access

The ground-floor flat provides step-free access from the street, making it suitable for a wide range of occupants. Circulation spaces are designed to be practical and usable, and bathrooms and kitchens are laid out to modern standards.

Refuse and Recycling

Adequate space is available for refuse and recycling storage in accordance with Doncaster Council requirements. Bin presentation and collection arrangements are consistent with existing residential practice along the street.

Sustainability

The proposal represents sustainable development through:

Any building work will be required to comply with current Building Regulations, including energy efficiency standards.



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Conclusion

The proposed change of use and rear extension at 55 St Catherine's Avenue represents a high-quality, policy-compliant form of residential development. This scheme delivers alignment with Doncaster Local Plan policies. It ensures full compliance with Nationally Described Space Standards. The development preserves local character and residential amenity. Furthermore, it contributes positively to Doncaster's housing supply. On this basis, the proposal is considered acceptable in planning terms and should be granted planning permission.

On this basis, the proposal is considered acceptable in planning terms and should be granted planning permission. We welcome any further questions or requests for clarification that might assist in your review. We look forward to collaborating constructively with you throughout the determination process.